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A reprieve, but still on edge over NIH money fight

Nonstop threats a cloud over key Mass. industry

By Tal Kopan, Sarah Rahal, and Allyson Chiu
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — When news began filtering out that the Trump administration was considering a new effort to put scientific funding under political control, a beleaguered Massachusetts research community braced itself for yet another devastating impact. When the administration last week reportedly backed off the plan, the community didn't feel much relief.

Though the administration appears to have punted this time, scientific grants have become an undeniable political

football under President Trump. With no sign of an end, no state has felt the stakes more dramatically than Massachusetts. It receives more National Institutes of Health funding per capita than any other state, and its research institutions and biomedical industry have felt the whipsaw of federal efforts to claw it back.

►Tracking the cuts by the Trump administration. B1.

"There's fatigue," said Scott Delaney, a former Harvard researcher who cofounded Grant Witness, which tracks terminated scientific research grants. He noted it's not just grants, as wider federal budget cuts feel like they touch every facet of society. "We're past

NIH, Page A13

'What Trump is trying to do is say, "We've never done anything wrong.'"

JOHN FROHNMAYER, NEA chairman
under George H.W. Bush

American history, as edited by Trump

Reframing past as a form of cultural control

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Soon in the nation's capital, American history will come with a warning sign.

END OF NORMALCY

Park Service is in the process of fabricating 12 displays at a cost of \$84,000 to be erected near the Smithsonian's National Museum of American History. They are intended to caution museum-goers that the historical interpretation they're about

At the best of President Trump, the National

to encounter is wrong — and deliberately so.

The Smithsonian's leaders "have altered the museum's role from accurately and coherently telling America's story to using the museum as a tool to advance personal, radical ideologies," Interior Secretary Doug Burgum said in a Sept. 3 letter to two US senators.

Among the topics the Trump administration has taken issue with: discussions of nonbinary gender expression, recognitions of structural racism, and using the term "undocumented immigrant" as opposed to "illegal alien."

Although the Smithsonian derives the bulk of its budget from congressional appropriations, it is not part of the federal

HISTORY, Page A16

Despite undeniable success, Metco seems frozen in time

BY JOHN HILLIARD | GLOBE STAFF

Eleven-year-old Daniella Daley's commute to school is measured not in city blocks but in highway miles. Each morning, a yellow bus picks her up in Dorchester, passes nearly a dozen Boston public schools, and heads north past schools in five other communities before she arrives at the Arthur W. Coolidge Middle School in Reading.

Daniella is in Metco, and her daily trip is nearly 50 miles because schools in many of Boston's closer suburbs are not open to Boston students like her.

For over 60 years, more than 20,000 predominantly Black and Hispanic children have made similar long journeys to distant schools in wealthier, mostly white suburbs, where they have thrived in higher performing classrooms.



Yet despite indisputable evidence of its academic achievements, Metco remains a Civil Rights-era experiment frozen in time. Its enrollment is roughly what it was when President Jimmy Carter was in office and not a single suburb has been added to the program in nearly a half-century, including some of Boston's immediate neighbors.

"Metco has shown us that this works, that it is worthy, that it is necessary, that it needs to be expanded," said Karilyn Crockett, an MIT assistant professor of urban history, public policy, and planning. "There's more to do."

Critics such as Crockett question why, after six decades, Massachusetts still relies on a modestly sized, voluntary desegregation effort instead of a bolder, comprehensive solution. The systemic inequities that gave rise to Metco remain in Boston, where classrooms almost entirely serving students of color still lag behind their largely white suburban counterparts.

An expensive housing market reinforces those longstanding racial divisions by limit-

METCO, Page A18



TOP: KEN MCGAGH FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE; ABOVE: GLOBE FILE

At top, Metco student Daniella Daley boarded a bus for the one-hour ride from Dorchester to Reading as her mother, Kemeisha Daley (right), looked on. Above, 60 years ago, Joan McLarin waved goodbye to her son, Milton, 13, as he headed for Braintree Junior High.

THE SEA THAT HE COULD SEE

Jadian O'Sullivan of Scituate was soaked by a wave as he went out to the breakwater in Scituate Harbor Saturday amid the nor'easter. Thousands lost power during the storm. B1.



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

In Leipzig, a warmer embrace for Nelsons

By Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

LEIPZIG, Germany — As director of the Leipzig Gewandhaus Orchestra, Andreas Schulz can't get his head around the Boston Symphony Orchestra's surprise decision to part ways with conductor Andris Nelsons, with some arguing he is stretched too thin by his many commitments and not in Boston enough.

The Leipzig orchestra is Nelsons' second musical home, and to Schulz, the Americans had the better end of the stick.

At least "in America, he was just doing Boston Symphony. He was not conducting any other American orchestras," Schulz said.

But in Europe, Nelsons also works with the Leipzig orchestra's direct competitors, including the legendary Vienna Philharmonic.

NELSONS, Page A19

Why have so many powerful people caved to pressure from the White House without putting up a fight? Globe Magazine.

The wet set

Sunday: More rain. High: 61-66. Low: 55-60
Monday: Much the same. Complete report, A26.

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